Seerah of the Prophet ﷺ

Birth of the Prophet ﷺ

1. Unanimous agreement on the **year of birth.**
    a. *Ibn al-Qayyim (may Allah have mercy on him) said:*

    "There is no difference of opinion concerning the fact that he (blessings and peace of Allah be upon him) was born in Makkah, and that his birth was in the Year of the Elephant." (Zad al-Ma'ad fi Hadiy Khayr al-'Ibad, 1/76)

    b. Musa b. Uqba was of the view that the birth occurred 30 years after the year of elephant.
2. There is a consensus according to Ibn al-Jawzi that the Prophet ﷺ was born in the month of Rabi al-Awwal. Some say it was Ramadan.
3. The **day** is known to be Monday based on a Saheeh Hadith

قَالَ وَسُئِلَ عَنْ صَوْمِ يَوْمِ الِاثْنَيْنِ قَالَ " ذَاكَ يَوْمٌ وُلِدْتُ فِيهِ وَيَوْمٌ بُعِثْتُ أَوْ أُنْزِلَ عَلَيَّ فِيهِ

(Muslim:1162- From Abu Qatadah)

4. No unanimous agreement on the **date**. Different dates presented are as follows:
    a. 2nd (al-Waqidi)
    b. 8th (az-Zuhri from Muhammad b. Jubayr b. Mut'im)
    c. 9th,
    d. 10th,
    e. 12th (Ibn-eIshaq, Ibn-e-Hisham, Dr. Ali Muhammad as-Sallabi),
    f. 17th,
    g. 22nd.

    According to *Sheikh Muhammad bin Saleh al-Munajjid*:

    "What appears to us to be the case is that the strongest opinion concerning the birth of the Prophet (blessings and peace of Allah be upon him) is that he was born between the eighth and the twelfth of Rabee' al-Awwal. Some Muslim mathematicians and astronomers have determined that the Monday in question was the ninth of Rabee' al-Awwal. It may be that this is another opinion, and it has some merit. That corresponds to 20th April 571 CE. This is what the authors of some modern books on Seerah (Prophet's biography) regard as most likely to be correct, including Professor Muhammad al-Khudari and Safi ar-Rahman al-Mubarakfuri."

5. *It was narrated from Khaalid ibn Ma'daan that the Companions of the Messenger of Allah (peace and blessings of Allah be upon him) said: "O Messenger of Allah, tell us about yourself."*

   He said: "I am the answer to the prayer of my father Ibraaheem, and the glad tidings of 'Eesa, and when my mother became pregnant with me, she saw something as if a light came out of her and illuminated the palaces of Busra in the land of Syria."

   Narrated by Ibn Ishaaq with his isnaad; Seerat Ibn Hishaam, 1/166. Narrated with a different isnaad by al-Tabari in his Tafseer, 1/566, and by al-Haakim in al-Mustadrak, 2/600. He said: its isnaad is saheeh although they [al-Bukhaari and Muslim] did not narrate, and al-Dhahabi agreed with him. See al-Silsilah al-Saheehah, 1545.

Fostering & Childhood

6. **Why the trend of wet nursing?**
   - **a.** Belief that child reared in desert would be tougher,
   - **b.** Healthier as they would be safer from diseases rampant in the cities and,
   - **c.** More eloquent in language as the Arabic of rural areas was purer than the cities.
   - **d.** Fostering in rural areas also helped children to develop their faculties according to many educational psychologists.
7. **Ladies who fostered the Prophet ﷺ**
   - **a. His biological mother, Aminah bint Wahb,**
   - b. **Thuwaibah, the bondwoman of Abu Lahb.** Through her the Prophet ﷺ had the following foster brothers:
     1. Hamza bin Abdul Muttalib,
     2. Abu Salamah,
     3. Abdullah bin Jahsh,
     4. Thuwaibah's son, Masrooh.

   - **c. Halimah Sa'diyah:**
     1. Belonged to the tribe of Banu Sa'd from the tribe Qais 'Ailan and she along with Banu Hawazin were settled in the suburbs of Taif.
     2. Abu Sufyan Bin Harith bin Abdul Muttalib was his foster brother through her.
     3. Many scholars believed that she accepted Islam.
     4. Story of fostering:
        a. Accompanied by her husband, her child who was also being nursed but due to her health in the draught he wasn't able

to get proper feed and would cry all night because of hunger due to which they couldn't get proper sleep, a female donkey and a female camel which would not give even a drop of milk, they left for Makkah to get a child.

b. It had been a year with a draught.
c. None liked to take the Prophet ﷺ as he was orphan and thinking that they won't get a good wage against him.
d. When every lady had a baby and she didn't, she took advice from his husband and took the Prophet ﷺ, not wanting to leave empty handed.
e. That very night, she was able to feed the Prophet ﷺ and her son as well. Also, her husband went to the camel and to his surprise the camel gave milk and all of them had a good night as they were all satiated.
f. Her husband realized that they had taken a blessed soul.
g. On their way back, the donkey was the fastest who was at the back all the time on their way to Makkah and kept the caravan lagging was now at the front with all the caravan at the back.
h. When home, their sheep would now give milk after grazing. People would ask their shepherds to take their cattle to the places from where the cattle of al-Harith ibn Abdul Uzza would graze from. But still, the sheep of Haleemah would come back and give milk whereas those of the other would not.
i. After the completion of fostering, they requested Aminah to give them more time to take the Prophet ﷺ with them (because of the blessings they got). Initially Aminah resisted, but as she was sick, she agreed.

2. Splitting of chest:

1. This incident took place when he ﷺ was around three or four years old.
2. Heart washed with Zamzam in a gold bowl and a black spot was removed.
3. Traces of this incident were physically visible as per the account of Anas bin Malik.

عَنْ أَنَسِ بْنِ مَالِكٍ، أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ أَتَاهُ جِبْرِيلُ ﷺ وَهُوَ يَلْعَبُ مَعَ الْغِلْمَانِ فَأَخَذَهُ فَصَرَعَهُ فَشَقَّ عَنْ قَلْبِهِ فَاسْتَخْرَجَ الْقَلْبَ فَاسْتَخْرَجَ مِنْهُ عَلَقَةً فَقَالَ هَذَا حَظُّ الشَّيْطَانِ مِنْكَ . ثُمَّ غَسَلَهُ فِي طَسْتٍ مِنْ ذَهَبٍ بِمَاءِ

زَمْزَمَ ثُمَّ لأَمَهُ ثُمَّ أَعَادَهُ فِي مَكَانِهِ وَجَاءَ الْغِلْمَانُ يَسْعَوْنَ إِلَى أُمِّهِ - يَعْنِي ظِئْرَهُ - فَقَالُوا إِنَّ مُحَمَّدًا قَدْ قُتِلَ . فَاسْتَقْبَلُوهُ وَهُوَ مُنْتَقِعُ اللَّوْنِ . قَالَ أَنَسٌ وَقَدْ كُنْتُ أَرَى أَثَرَ ذَلِكَ الْمِخْيَطِ فِي صَدْرِهِ

Anas b. Malik reported that Gabriel came to the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) while he was playing with his playmates. He took hold of him and lay him prostrate on the ground and tore open his breast and took out the heart from it and then extracted a blood-clot out of it and said:

That was the part of Satan in thee. And then he washed it with the water of Zamzam in a golden basin and then it was joined together and restored to it place. The boys came running to his mother, i. e. his nurse, and said: Verily Muhammad has been murdered. They all rushed toward him (and found him all right) His color was changed, Anas said. I myself saw the marks of needle on his breast.

(Muslim: 162)

Lessons

- The one whom Allah wants to protect; none can harm. And the one whom Allah harms, no one can protect.
- Allah choses the best for his servant. As Haleemah didn't want to take the Prophet ﷺ, but Allah gave her the best child of the city without her realizing this fact.
- These are the mere blessings of the Prophet ﷺ before his Prophethood and as a small boy, Imagine the immense blessings one will achieve if he obeys the Prophet ﷺ.
- It is important that we take time to contemplate the signs (universe and the creation) in our daily lives and give ourselves relief from this robotic lifestyle.
- This splitting of chest was done to assure that the Prophet ﷺ is saved from any sort of thing that may tarnish his character and save him from satan in every way.
- Allah made this event a physical event, which could have been only spiritual as well, so we must realize that the sharee'ah emphasizes on means.
- The soul has effect on the body and vice versa.

3. Death of Aminah:

1. Visits Yathrib to meet the relatives from Banu Najjar. These relatives were the maternal relatives of the grandfather of the Prophet ﷺ. Also, one of the reasons quoted is the grave of Abdullah was also there in Yathrib so Aminah would visit it.
2. Stay was about a month.
3. Died on her way back to Makkah in a place called al-Abwa.
4. Umm-e-Ayman, the slave girl of Aminah, was with them in this journey and took him ﷺ back to Makkah.

5. The death of Aminah brought back the pain of Abdullah for Abdul-Muttalib and this made him even more sensitive with regards to his grandson.

- The pain the Prophet ﷺ went through in his childhood and throughout his life and the gratitude he ﷺ showed despite these difficulties.
- To keep him ﷺ away from the lure of comfort, wealth and power.
- No one could blame him ﷺ in the future that (if he had wealth and power before Prophethood) that he did that to supplement his temporal power.
- Leadership requires gentleness to the weak and wakefulness for their protection.

4. Treatment of Abd al-Muttalib with the Prophet ﷺ:

1. The mat on which Abd al-Muttalib would sit and the Prophet ﷺ would sit on it or around it with Abdul Muttalib as a young boy and his uncles would try to move him from there and Abd al-Muttalib would ask them to leave him alone.
2. It was not long that the Prophet ﷺ was again destined to become an orphan and at a tender age of 8, he had to bid farewell to his loving grandfather as well.